

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 22

By Clemmons

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of John Richard "Dick" Lodge, Jr., of Nashville.

WHEREAS, we were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of John Richard "Dick" Lodge, Jr., a longtime General Assembly lobbyist and friend to many on Capitol Hill; and

WHEREAS, born in Sewanee on June 16, 1949, Dick Lodge was the son of Reverend John Richard Lodge and Sarah Virginia "Pat" Lodge; he traveled with his family a great deal during his youth, from Alabama to Alaska, ultimately graduating from Escambia County High School in Atmore, Alabama; and

WHEREAS, after graduating from the University of the South (Sewanee) in 1971, he earned his Juris Doctor degree from Vanderbilt University Law School in 1974, thereafter working in the State Attorney General's Office for two years, at which time he joined the campaign to elect Jim Sasser to the U.S. Senate, which ultimately proved successful; and

WHEREAS, Dick Lodge accompanied Senator Sasser to Washington, D.C., to become his first legislative director, a fortuitous endeavor, as it was there that he met his future wife, Gina, who was working for Senator Patrick Moynihan; and

WHEREAS, Dick and Gina Lodge married in 1978 and returned to Nashville for Mr. Lodge to join the law firm of Willis and Knight; during his early years in private practice, he become known as a phenomenal chef, which owed much to his family's background in the cast iron skillet business and his wife's encouragement; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Lodge was elected to serve as Tennessee Democratic Party chair in 1983; he headed the committee of Southern States to create Super Tuesday during his five-year tenure, before joining Bass, Berry & Sims, where he became a partner and headed the firm's first Government Relations practice area; and

WHEREAS, concurrently with his work at Bass, Berry & Sims, which began in 1985 and spanned thirty-three years, Mr. Lodge was active in local and state government and was appointed by Mayor Phil Bredesen as the first chair of the Nashville Sports Authority in 1995; his service to his community extended to include serving as senior warden at Christ Church Cathedral, president of Legal Services of Middle Tennessee, and an early supporter of Thistle Farms; and

WHEREAS, above all, Dick Lodge was wholly devoted to his friends and his family, always endeavoring to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, he is survived by his beloved wife of forty-six years, Virginia "Gina" Tyler Lodge; his children, Sarah Lodge (Trey) Tally and Richard Matthew (Rachael) Lodge; his grandchildren, Virginia Frances Tally, Earl Burton "E.B." Tally IV, John Richard "Jack" Lodge III, and Josephine Bright Lodge; his siblings, Henry (Donna) Lodge, Sarah Lodge, and David (Andrea) Lodge; and many nephews, nieces, great-nephews, and great-nieces; and

WHEREAS, Dick Lodge was a true and loyal friend, a valued mentor, and a blessing to all who had the good fortune of knowing him; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Lodge leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of John Richard "Dick" Lodge, Jr., reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Lodge.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.